Rising Prices Worry Voters Before a Big US Election

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Americans will vote in the **midterm elections** on November 3. These elections decide who controls the US **Congress**. Many voters are worried about prices going up. That is called **inflation**.

For almost a year, President Donald Trump has told voters not to worry about prices. He has said gas and **diesel** prices would fall soon. Those prices went up a lot after the war with Iran began.

But **polls** show many voters are not convinced. On average, more than 70 percent of people in recent **polls** do not like how Trump has handled **inflation**, according to Silver Bulletin.

New government numbers showed that prices in September were 3.7 percent higher than a year before. Fuel and clothing went up the most.

Spencer Kimball of Emerson College Polling said everyday costs are what worry voters most. Trump has been visiting states like Alaska, Kansas, Ohio and Texas to help Republicans running for the US Senate.

Word Treasure

midterm elections -- Elections held in the middle of a president's term to choose members of Congress.

Congress -- The group of lawmakers who write the laws for the United States.

inflation -- When prices go up over time, so money buys less.

polls -- Surveys that ask many people what they think.

diesel -- A kind of fuel used by trucks, buses and some cars.

Background you need

Every two years, Americans vote for members of Congress, and the elections in the middle of a president's term are called midterms.

Congress makes the country's laws, so the party that wins more seats has more power.

When the prices of things like gas and clothes rise, families have to spend more money for the same things.

Break it down

WHO: President Donald Trump and American voters
WHAT: Many voters are worried about rising prices before the elections
WHERE: Across the United States, including Alaska, Kansas, Ohio and Texas
WHY: Prices, especially for fuel and clothing, have gone up

Why it matters

When prices rise, families may have to spend more on things like gas and clothes.

Test what you remember

1. When are the midterm elections?

- (A) November 3
- (B) January 1
- (C) July 4
- (D) October 31

2. What is inflation?

- (A) Prices going up
- (B) A poll
- (C) A kind of election
- (D) A type of fuel

3. How much higher were prices in September than a year before?

- (A) 17 percent
- (B) 70 percent
- (C) 3.7 percent
- (D) 1 percent

4. Which things went up the most?

- (A) Food and water
- (B) Toys and games
- (C) Fuel and clothing
- (D) Phones and computers

5. What do more than 70 percent of people in recent polls not like?

- (A) Sports teams
- (B) School lunches
- (C) The weather
- (D) How Trump has handled inflation

6. Which state is one that Trump has visited?

- (A) Alaska
- (B) Maine
- (C) Florida
- (D) Hawaii

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. President Donald Trump: Has told voters not to worry and said gas and diesel prices would fall soon.

2. Spencer Kimball, Emerson College Polling: Says everyday costs are what worry voters most.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):